



Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/23

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

May/June 2025

INSERT

2 hours

INFORMATION

- This insert contains the reading texts.
- You may annotate this insert and use the blank spaces for planning. **Do not write your answers** on the insert.



This document has 4 pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Read **both** texts and then answer **Question 1** on the question paper.

Text A

The following text is an article written by a professional photographer.

'Why do you take pictures?'

Content removed due to copyright restrictions.

These are the images that tell your story.

Text B

The following text is an article about how photography has changed.

I wonder how famous photographers of the past would have handled the digital revolution unleashed in recent years? We are obsessed with ourselves, and with how others see us, and with how we view others. We do not take pictures for ourselves (if we did, we would not share them on social media) but to appeal to complete strangers in the vacuum of the internet. We don't even take photos of ourselves, but of what we aspire to be. If a photo doesn't do that – well, a click of a button erases it. Our online presence takes precedence over being present in our own lives.

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Every one of us, even those like me who criticise such things, has a storehouse of images. On a recent trip to the mountains, I struggled not to take too many photos of the beautiful snowy surroundings. How about trying to record those beautiful memories with your mind's eye rather than snap one photo after another and lose that special moment? Maybe remember your child's smile, brimming with enthusiasm on their first attempt on the slope, or how their rosy, cold cheeks felt against yours, rather than trying to capture the 'perfect' moment? So successful has the camera's role become that photographs, rather than the world, have become the standard for what's beautiful. Instead of just recording reality, photographs have become the norm for the way things appear to us.

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I asked a famous photojournalist, 'Are there times when you simply witness the moment without taking a picture?' He gave me this thought-provoking answer: 'There are personal moments that are magical, and I keep them for me. But images can tell important stories to the public too.'

I have often taken a moment to think before pushing the button and I sometimes hear myself saying: 'Don't spoil the moment, don't take a photo.'

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Unfortunately, needing to have reality confirmed and experience enhanced by photographs is a kind of consumerism to which we're all now addicted.

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Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

May/June 2025

2 hours

You must answer on the question paper.

You will need: Insert (enclosed)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **two** questions in total:
Section A: answer Question 1.
Section B: answer **one** question.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **12** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.





Read Text A and Text B in the insert and then answer **Section A, Question 1** on this question paper.

Section A: Directed writing

Question 1

Your school has organised a visit to an area of great natural beauty. To appreciate the experience more fully, the headteacher has decided that students will only be allowed access to their mobile phones in an emergency, not to take pictures.

Write a letter to the headteacher giving your views on this decision.

In your letter, you should:

- evaluate the ideas, attitudes and opinions given in the texts
- consider whether the experience will be more rewarding with or without the ability to take pictures.

Base your letter on what you have read in **both** texts, but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

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[40]



[Turn to page 6 for Section B.]



Section B: Composition

Answer **one** question from Section B.

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this question paper.

Up to 16 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer and up to 24 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

EITHER**Descriptive writing**

- 2 Describe an uncomfortable ride on public transport.

OR**Descriptive writing**

- 3 Describe someone working outdoors.

OR**Narrative writing**

- 4 Write a story which involves making a new friendship.

OR**Narrative writing**

- 5 Write a story with the title, 'The last one'.





This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of approximately 20 horizontal rows. Each row is defined by two parallel dotted lines, creating a series of uniform gaps for letter height. The entire page is otherwise blank, with no text or other markings.

[40]

[40]

[illegible]



Additional page

If you use the following page to complete the answer to any question, the question number must be clearly shown.

[illegible]



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